ALGERIAN TRAVEL AGENCY

Website & Management Platform

Functional Requirements & Product Scope

A practical specification for a website you can build, demonstrate, and sell to a travel agency in Algeria.

Product type	Public travel website + private agency back-office + optional customer portal
Primary market	Small and medium-sized travel agencies in Algeria
Languages	Arabic (RTL), French (LTR), with English as an optional later addition
Currency	Algerian dinar (DZD / DA)
Delivery approach	Start with a manageable MVP; add integrations and advanced workflows later

Prepared as a product-planning document • Version 1.0 • November 2026

1. Product vision

The product should help a travel agency present its services online and manage the daily work behind those services from one system.

Recommended product: a responsive public website connected to a secure administration dashboard. Customers discover trips and submit booking requests; agency employees manage customers, offers, reservations, documents and payments.

Important scope decision: the first version should manage booking requests and agency-confirmed reservations. It does not need to issue airline tickets, connect to live airline inventory, or guarantee live hotel availability. Those integrations are separate, more complex projects.

The platform should be configurable for each agency: its name, logo, contact details, branches, services, branding, languages and published offers.

1.1 Main goals

- Give the agency a professional online presence that works well on phones.
- Turn website visitors into enquiries and booking requests.
- Keep customer, reservation, payment and document information organized.
- Reduce duplicate data entry, paper tracking and spreadsheet dependence.
- Give the owner a clear overview of bookings, outstanding balances and upcoming departures.

1.2 User groups

User	Main needs
Website visitor	Discover destinations, services, offers, agency details and contact options.
Customer	Send a request, provide required details, upload documents when requested, and check booking progress.
Agency employee	Manage enquiries, customers, offers, reservations, documents and payments.
Agency manager / owner	Manage staff access, business settings, reports, financial overview and operational activity.

2. Public website functionalities

This is the part visible to everyone. It should be fast, trustworthy, mobile-friendly and easy for agency staff to update.

2.1 Essential pages

Page	Required functionality
Home	Agency introduction, featured offers, popular destinations, services, trust indicators and clear enquiry/WhatsApp calls to action.
About the agency	Agency profile, experience, values, licence/accreditation details where applicable, address and branches.
Travel offers	Searchable/filterable list of published trips and packages, with price, dates, destination and availability label.
Offer details	Description, itinerary, departure/return dates, price, included/excluded services, accommodation details, conditions, gallery and enquiry form.
Services	Separate pages for tourism, domestic trips, international trips, hotel reservations, visa assistance, Umrah/Hajj services if offered, and other agency services.
Destinations	Destination pages with descriptions, photos, travel information and linked offers.
Contact	Phone numbers, WhatsApp link, email, office address, map, opening hours and contact form.
FAQ	Answers to common questions about booking, payment, documents, cancellation and travel conditions.
Legal pages	Privacy notice, website terms, booking conditions and cookie notice if applicable.

2.2 Travel offer catalogue

- Staff can create, edit, publish, unpublish and archive offers.
- Each offer can have destination, trip type, start/end dates, duration, price in DZD, pricing basis (per person, room, family, etc.), capacity, hotel/accommodation, transport details and description.
- Support photos, itinerary/day-by-day programme, included services, excluded services and downloadable brochure.
- Display clear offer states such as Available, Limited places, Request availability and Fully booked. Do not show live availability unless the agency actually maintains it.
- Allow filters such as destination, trip type, date range and budget where the agency has enough offers to justify them.

2.3 Enquiry and booking request forms

- Collect the customer's name, phone number, email (optional or required by agency policy), selected offer, number of travellers, preferred dates and message.
- Validate required fields and show a clear confirmation after submission.
- Create an enquiry record in the dashboard and notify the responsible agency staff.
- Record consent to the privacy notice where required.
- Clearly explain that submitting a request is not a confirmed reservation until the agency confirms it.

2.4 Trust, usability and conversion

- Prominent phone and WhatsApp contact actions on mobile.
- Real agency address, map, office hours and verified contact details.
- Testimonials only when genuine and approved for publication.
- Clear prices, conditions, inclusions and exclusions; avoid hidden fees.
- Accessible typography, readable contrast, optimized images and simple navigation.

3. Agency administration dashboard

The back-office is the core operational product. Only authenticated and authorized staff should access it.

3.1 Dashboard overview

- Show enquiries awaiting response, active reservations, upcoming departures and tasks requiring attention.
- Show total payments received and outstanding customer balances for a selected period.
- Provide shortcuts to add a customer, create an offer, register a reservation and record a payment.
- Allow filtering by date, employee, trip and reservation status.

3.2 Customer / CRM management

- Create, view, edit, archive and search customer profiles.
- Store name, contact details, preferred language and internal notes.
- Store traveller information only when needed for a booking, with restricted access to sensitive fields.
- View a customer's enquiries, reservations, payments and relevant documents in one history.
- Detect likely duplicate customers by phone number or email and let staff review matches.

3.3 Enquiry management

- Receive requests submitted through the website and allow staff to create enquiries manually (phone, walk-in or WhatsApp).
- Assign an enquiry to an employee and set a follow-up date.
- Track status: New, Contacted, Waiting for customer, Converted, Rejected or Closed.
- Keep a timestamped activity history and internal notes.

3.4 Reservation management

- Create a reservation from an enquiry or directly from the dashboard.
- Link the reservation to a customer, offer, travellers and responsible employee.
- Store booking date, travel dates, passenger count, agreed price, discount if authorized and special requirements.
- Track status: Pending, Awaiting documents, Awaiting payment, Confirmed, Cancelled or Completed.
- Generate a reservation reference number and printable confirmation.
- Maintain a history of status changes; do not silently overwrite important changes.

3.5 Group trips and capacity

- Create a departure/group linked to an offer, with departure date, return date and maximum capacity.
- Track booked places, available places and a waiting list if needed.
- Prevent staff from confirming more places than the configured capacity unless a manager explicitly overrides it.
- Allow one offer to have multiple departure dates.

3.6 Payment tracking

- Record an agreed total price, deposits, subsequent instalments and remaining balance.
- Record payment date, amount, method, reference and employee who entered it.
- Support cash, bank transfer and other payment methods configured by the agency.
- Generate a receipt for each recorded payment and show the payment history.
- Flag overdue or incomplete balances based on agency-defined due dates.
- Keep an audit trail for edits, cancellations and refunds.

The first release can record payments manually. Online card payment, bank reconciliation and automated payment confirmation should be treated as later integrations.

4. Documents, employees and reports

4.1 Document management

- Attach files to a customer or reservation, with document type, upload date, expiry date (if relevant) and status.
- Examples: passport copy, identity document, visa-related file, contract, itinerary, insurance document and payment receipt.
- Use private storage; never expose uploaded identity or passport documents through public URLs.
- Restrict document access by role and log sensitive access or changes where practical.
- Support download, replacement and deletion according to the agency's retention policy and applicable law.

4.2 Employee and access management

Role	Suggested permissions
Owner / Administrator	All modules, agency settings, users, reports and permission management.
Manager	Operational modules, staff assignments, reports and approved overrides.
Reservation agent	Customers, enquiries, offers (if permitted), reservations and trip documents.
Finance employee	Payment records, receipts, balances and financial reports; limited access to unrelated documents.
Content editor	Public website pages, destinations, images and offers; no access to private financial/customer records unless explicitly granted.

Use role-based access control (RBAC), individual staff accounts, secure password handling, session management and account deactivation when an employee leaves.

4.3 Reports and exports

- Reservations by period, destination, offer and status.
- Revenue collected versus amounts still due; clearly distinguish cash received from booked sales.
- Upcoming departures, passenger lists and capacity summaries.
- Enquiry conversion: received, followed up, converted and closed.
- Export permitted data to CSV or PDF for operational use.
- Apply date filters and restrict financial reports to authorized roles.

4.4 Notifications and communication

- In-dashboard alerts for new enquiries, upcoming departures, missing documents and due payments.
- Email notifications for enquiry receipt and reservation updates if email is configured.
- WhatsApp click-to-chat links with prefilled message templates; sending automated WhatsApp messages requires an approved provider/API and setup.
- Allow staff to record that a customer was contacted and when.

5. Optional customer portal

The portal can be delivered after the public website and agency dashboard are working. It adds value but should not delay the first usable release.

- Customer receives a secure invitation or booking link associated with their reservation.
- Customer can view reservation reference, trip details, current status and payment balance.
- Customer can upload requested documents through a protected upload flow.
- Customer can download confirmation, itinerary and receipts.
- Customer can submit a question or request a correction.
- The portal must show only that customer's information and must not expose other travellers' records.

6. Algeria-specific requirements

Area	Requirement / design consideration
Languages	Arabic and French at minimum; Arabic pages use proper right-to-left layout, French pages use left-to-right layout. Keep translations manageable in the admin system.
Currency	Display DZD / DA consistently. Store amounts as decimal values and keep currency explicit in financial records.
Contact details	Support Algerian mobile/landline formats and configurable agency contact numbers.
Dates and time	Use clear date formats and Algeria local time for operational schedules; store timestamps consistently in the backend.
Payments	Start with manual recording of cash and bank transfers. Add local electronic payment integrations only after checking provider eligibility, commercial terms and technical documentation.
Documents	Treat passport and identity documents as highly sensitive. Minimize collection, limit access, protect storage and define retention/deletion rules.
Legal and tax	Have the agency and its accountant/legal adviser validate contract wording, invoice/receipt formats, tax handling, privacy notices and sector-specific requirements.
Hosting	Choose hosting based on data protection, reliability, support, backups, latency and the agency's contractual needs.
Connectivity	Optimize for mobile networks and slower connections: compressed images, light pages and graceful form recovery.

Do not claim that the software is legally or tax compliant merely because it generates an invoice or stores customer data. Confirm the current Algerian requirements with qualified local professionals.

7. Recommended development priorities

Build a complete, reliable workflow before adding every possible module. The following scope is suitable for a first sellable pilot with one agency.

Phase 1 — Sellable MVP

Priority	Functionality	Acceptance outcome
Must	Public home, about, contact and services pages	Agency can publish a professional website with accurate contact details.
Must	Travel offers catalogue and offer detail pages	Visitors can browse current offers and understand what is included.
Must	Enquiry / booking request form	A submitted request is validated, saved and visible to staff.
Must	Staff login and roles	Only authorized staff can access the back-office.
Must	Customer management	Staff can create, update, search and view customer history.
Must	Offer management	Staff can create, publish, update and archive offers.
Must	Reservation management	Staff can convert an enquiry into a reservation and track its status.
Must	Manual payment tracking	Staff can record deposits and instalments and see remaining balances.
Must	Basic receipts / confirmation PDF	Staff can generate a printable customer document.
Must	Arabic/French responsive UI	Main public and admin workflows work on desktop and mobile.
Should	Basic dashboard and reports	Owner can see active bookings, upcoming trips and payment totals.
Should	Private document uploads	Staff can securely attach and retrieve permitted files.

Phase 2 — Operational improvements

- Group departures, seat capacity and passenger lists.
- Customer portal and secure document submission.
- Email notifications and WhatsApp communication workflows.
- More detailed financial reports, expenses and refunds.
- Employee assignments, task reminders and audit logs.

Phase 3 — Advanced integrations

- Online payment provider integration after commercial and technical validation.
- External hotel, airline, insurance or booking-provider integrations where APIs and agency access are available.
- Accounting exports, multi-branch support and advanced analytics.
- Automated document workflows and configurable approval steps.

8. Core business workflows

8.1 Website enquiry to confirmed reservation

Step	System behaviour
1. Discover	Visitor opens an offer and reads its dates, price and conditions.
2. Request	Visitor submits a booking/enquiry form.
3. Receive	System creates an enquiry and alerts the agency team.
4. Follow up	Employee contacts the customer, records notes and updates enquiry status.
5. Confirm details	Employee checks availability and requirements with the agency's actual suppliers/processes.
6. Reserve	Employee creates or confirms the reservation and assigns a reference.
7. Payment	Employee records deposit or instalment and generates a receipt.
8. Prepare	Employee tracks required documents and upcoming departure tasks.
9. Complete	Reservation is marked completed, cancelled or otherwise closed with a recorded reason.

8.2 Key business rules

- An enquiry is not automatically a confirmed booking.
- A reservation should not be marked confirmed until an authorized employee has checked the agency's required conditions.
- The remaining balance is calculated from the agreed total minus recorded payments, with refunds and adjustments represented explicitly.
- Every reservation must have a unique reference.
- Changing an offer price must not silently change the agreed price of an existing reservation.
- Deleting financial or reservation history should be restricted; prefer cancellation, archive or reversal records.
- A departure's capacity must be checked before confirming a new place.

9. Non-functional requirements: quality, security and reliability

Category	Requirement
Security	HTTPS in production; password hashing; input validation; protection against common web vulnerabilities; secure session/token handling.
Authorization	Enforce permissions on the backend for every protected operation, not only by hiding frontend buttons.
Sensitive files	Private file storage, access checks, upload size/type limits, malware scanning where available, and no public document links.
Privacy	Collect only necessary personal data; publish a clear privacy notice; define retention and deletion procedures.
Auditability	Record important actions such as payment edits, reservation status changes, permission changes and document updates.
Backups	Automated database backups, protected backup access and periodically tested restore procedures.
Reliability	Handle failed form submissions and notification errors safely; avoid duplicate reservations on repeated requests.
Performance	Optimize images, paginate long lists, index commonly searched database fields and avoid loading unnecessary data.
Accessibility	Keyboard-friendly forms, readable contrast, labels and clear validation messages.
Maintainability	Use modular code, documented APIs, migrations, automated tests and separate development/production settings.
Localization	Support RTL/LTR layouts, translation files, localized dates and consistent currency formatting.

Minimum test scenarios

- A visitor can submit a valid request; invalid requests show useful validation messages.
- An unauthorized user cannot open the admin dashboard or call protected API endpoints.
- An employee cannot view a document or financial record outside their permission scope.
- A customer cannot access another customer's reservation by changing a URL or identifier.
- Repeated form submission does not unintentionally create duplicate reservations.
- Payment totals and outstanding balances remain correct after multiple instalments and refunds.
- A database backup can be restored in a test environment.

10. Suggested technical structure

A modular monolith is recommended for the first version: one backend application organized into clear modules, one relational database and one frontend. This is easier to build and deploy than microservices while leaving room to scale later.

10.1 Suggested backend modules

Module	Responsibilities
auth	Login, password reset, sessions/tokens, roles and permissions.
agency	Agency profile, branding, branches, contact details and settings.
website_content	Pages, services, destinations, FAQs, images and published content.
offers	Travel packages, departure dates, pricing and publication status.
customers	Customer profiles, traveller details and customer history.
enquiries	Website requests, follow-ups, assignment and status history.
reservations	Bookings, passengers, status, reference and trip association.
payments	Payments, receipts, balances, refunds and financial audit trail.
documents	Protected file metadata, access rules and document status.
notifications	Email/in-app notification records and delivery status.
reports	Aggregated operational and financial summaries.

10.2 Suggested core database entities

Agency, User, Role, Permission, Branch, WebsitePage, Service, Destination, TravelOffer, Departure, Customer, Traveller, Enquiry, EnquiryActivity, Reservation, ReservationTraveller, Payment, Refund, Document, Notification, AuditLog.

Use foreign keys and database constraints for relationships and important business rules. Keep a reservation's agreed price as a snapshot so later offer edits do not rewrite historical bookings.

10.3 Suggested technology stack

Layer	Suggested choice
Frontend	React + TypeScript
Styling / UI	Tailwind CSS and a reusable component library
Backend API	Python + FastAPI
Database	PostgreSQL
ORM / migrations	SQLAlchemy + Alembic
Authentication	Secure cookie-based sessions or carefully implemented access/refresh tokens; role-based permissions.
File storage	Private object storage or protected server storage; keep file metadata in PostgreSQL.
PDF generation	HTML-to-PDF or a PDF library for confirmations and receipts.
Deployment	Docker and Docker Compose for the first deployment.
Testing	Pytest for backend; frontend component and end-to-end tests.

11. Features to postpone (avoid making the first version too complex)

- Live flight search, airline ticket issuance and real-time seat inventory.
- Live hotel inventory and automatic supplier booking.
- Automatic visa approval predictions or promises.
- Complex accounting, payroll and tax filing.
- Native iOS/Android apps; make the website responsive first.
- AI chatbot, recommendation engine and automatic pricing.
- Microservices, Kubernetes and complicated distributed infrastructure.
- Multi-agency marketplace where many agencies sell through one public platform.

These features may be valuable later, but they depend on external providers, legal/commercial agreements or substantial operational complexity.

12. Preparing the product to sell to an agency

A software product sold to an agency needs more than features. It must be configurable, supportable and easy to hand over.

- Agency branding: logo, colors, contact details, office locations and social links.
- Content control: agency staff can update offers, photos, pages and FAQs without editing code.
- Deployment and domain setup: production domain, HTTPS, backups and environment configuration.
- Training: short user guide and onboarding session for the agency's employees.
- Support: a defined process for bug reports, updates, backups and recovery.
- Data ownership: clear agreement about who owns customer data, how it can be exported and what happens if the contract ends.
- Commercial terms: setup fee, hosting/maintenance fee, support scope, update policy and any third-party costs.
- Acceptance testing: run realistic workflows with agency staff before final delivery.

12.1 Suggested acceptance checklist

- Agency can log in and manage staff accounts.
- Agency can publish and unpublish a travel offer.
- A visitor can submit an enquiry from a phone.
- Staff can convert the enquiry into a reservation.
- Staff can record multiple payments and produce a receipt.
- Staff can attach a private document and retrieve it only with permission.
- Arabic and French layouts display correctly.
- Owner can view basic booking and payment reports.
- Backups and restore procedure are demonstrated.
- Agency staff have tested the system and approved the workflow.

13. Recommended first release

The best first release is not a complete travel-industry ERP. It is a professional agency website connected to a small but dependable operations dashboard.

Include in first release	Keep for later
Home, about, services, contact and FAQ	Native mobile applications
Travel offers catalogue and detail pages	Live airline and hotel integrations
Enquiry / booking request form	Automated ticket issuance
Staff authentication and roles	Advanced accounting and payroll
Customer and enquiry management	AI chatbot and recommendations
Reservations and status tracking	Multi-agency marketplace
Manual payment records and receipts	Online payment until provider is selected
Basic documents and reports	Complex analytics and automation
Arabic/French responsive design	Additional languages if not needed by pilot

Suggested pilot: configure the system for one real travel agency, enter a small set of real offers, train a few employees, and observe how they handle enquiries, reservations and payments. Use their feedback to decide what to build next.

14. Assumptions and items to confirm with the agency

- Which services does the agency actually sell: outbound trips, domestic tourism, Umrah/Hajj, visa assistance, hotels, transport or other services?
- Does the agency need only enquiry forms, or does it already have supplier systems/APIs for confirmed bookings?
- How does it currently track customers, reservations, deposits, instalments, refunds and expenses?
- Which documents does it collect, who can access them and how long must they be retained?
- Which payment methods does it accept, and what receipt/invoice format does its accountant require?
- Does it have multiple branches, employees and approval steps?
- Who will update the website offers and content after launch?
- Does it require Arabic and French from launch, and who will provide/approve translations?
- What hosting, support, backup and data-export arrangements does the agency expect?

Final product principle: build around the agency's real workflow, not a long feature checklist. A smaller system that staff use every day is more valuable than a large system that is difficult to operate.

This document is a product and technical planning specification, not legal, accounting, tax or regulatory advice. Validate current Algerian obligations and third-party integration terms before production use.